

COLD STRESS TOOLBOX TALK

Control hypothermia and frostbite risks in cold, windy and wet conditions.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Prevent hypothermia, cold injury and loss of dexterity during work in cold, windy or wet conditions.

KEY HAZARDS

1  Low air temperature.	2  High wind speed.	3  Wet clothing.	4  Prolonged outdoor exposure.
5  Bare-skin contact with cold metal.	6  Loss of dexterity and grip strength.	7  Hypothermia.	8  Frostbite and tissue damage.

CRITICAL POINTS TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

01 Low air temperature.	02 High wind speed.	03 Wet clothing.
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REMEMBER — SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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FIELD REQUIREMENTS AND VERIFICATION

Prevent hypothermia, cold injury and loss of dexterity during work in cold, windy or wet conditions.

SERNEM FIELD 01
FIELD VERIFICATION 1
Weather assessed

SERNEM FIELD 02
FIELD VERIFICATION 2
Clothing dry

SERNEM FIELD 03
FIELD VERIFICATION 3
Layers suitable

SERNEM FIELD 04
FIELD VERIFICATION 4
Hand protection suitable

VERIFICATION BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Weather assessed | ☐ Clothing dry |
| ☐ Layers suitable | ☐ Hand protection suitable |
| ☐ Foot protection suitable | ☐ Warm area available |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- What are today's temperature and wind conditions?
- Where is the warming area?
- Are dry replacement gloves and clothing available?

FIELD APPLICATION



Control hypothermia and frostbite risks in cold, windy and wet conditions.

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES

1. ELIMINATE / REDUCE THE RISK

Assess temperature and wind conditions. • Provide planned warm-up breaks. • Watch for hypothermia and frostbite symptoms.

2. ENGINEERING & PHYSICAL CONTROLS

Wear dry layered clothing. • Reduce prolonged stationary work. • Stop work and move affected workers to a warm area.

3. WORK METHOD & FIELD CONTROLS

Protect hands, feet and head. • Avoid direct contact with cold metal.

4. PPE, VERIFICATION & SUPERVISION

Replace wet clothing promptly. • Use a buddy system to monitor workers.

CRITICAL WARNING



Team, if conditions are cold and windy today we will consider wind and wetness as well as temperature. Do not continue working in wet gloves or clothing. Report numbness or uncontrolled shivering immediately.

SITE CHECKLIST — BEFORE STARTING WORK

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Weather assessed | ☐ Clothing dry |
| ☐ Layers suitable | ☐ Hand protection suitable |
| ☐ Foot protection suitable | ☐ Warm area available |
| ☐ Break plan established | ☐ Buddy system active |
| ☐ Symptoms explained | ☐ Crew briefed |



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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			